

Risk Assessment No: WP-013				Task: Hot Works on the Wash Plant — Welding, Cutting, Grinding						
Prepared By: Derick Bibby					Date: 02.08.2026			RA Review Date: 01.08.2027		
					Reviewed By: Lee Hardy			Date: 02.08.2026		
PPE: Safety Footwear, High Visibility Jacket, High Visibility Trousers, Hard Hat, Gloves, Ear Defenders, Mask, Eye Protection										
Hazard	Persons at Risk	L	S	R	Control Measures			L	S	R
Ignition of hydraulic oil, diesel, dust, combustible residues by spark or heat	Welder / Cutter Fire watcher All personnel	3	5	15	- Hot Works Permit issued only after combustibles removed / protected within 10 m. - Fire watcher present during and for 60 minutes after works. - Foam and CO₂ extinguishers within reach of the work area. - Hydraulic and fuel lines protected with fire blanket or removed from proximity. - Gas cylinders secured upright, chained to cart, valves shut when not in use.			1	5	5
Exposure to welding fume, cutting fume and hot gases	Welder / Cutter	4	3	12	- Local exhaust ventilation (LEV) or on-torch fume extraction where available. - RPE (powered air-purifying respirator) for confined or poorly ventilated work. - Welding fume health surveillance under COSHH for regular welders. - No welding on painted, galvanised or contaminated surfaces without additional controls.			2	3	6
Arc radiation, UV, IR burns and eye damage	Welder / Cutter Others in vicinity	4	3	12	- Welding shield / auto-darkening helmet correct shade for process. - Welding screens around work area to protect others from arc flash. - Long-sleeved fire-retardant overalls, welding gauntlets, spats. - Signage — "Do not look at arc" at boundary.			2	3	6
Fire — hydraulic oil, diesel, electrical fault, hot works	All personnel Site neighbours	3	5	15	- Hot works permit required for welding, cutting or grinding. - Fire extinguishers (CO₂ and foam) at MCC, filter press and oil skid — serviced annually. - Fire evacuation plan tested; assembly points marked and known at induction. - No smoking outside designated area. - Housekeeping to prevent accumulation of combustibles.			1	5	5
Stored energy — hydraulic accumulators, pneumatic receivers	Maintenance Contractors	3	5	15	- Bleed hydraulic accumulators to zero pressure and confirm via gauge before opening manifolds. - Drain air receivers to zero via test valve before hose or fitting removal. - Padlock the isolator on the pump or compressor supplying the circuit. - PSSR examination of accumulators and receivers at statutory interval.			1	5	5
Noise exposure ≥ 85 dB	All plant personnel	4	3	12	- Noise survey identifies zones ≥ 85 dB — mandatory hearing protection signage. - Ear defenders SNR ≥ 27 dB issued and worn in mandatory zones.			2	3	6

					• Audiometry health surveillance for staff regularly on the plant footprint. • Noise-reducing enclosures maintained where fitted; damaged panels reported.			
Manual handling of screen media, cloths, cyclone parts, hoses	Maintenance Operator	4	3	12	• Task-based manual handling assessment for screen cloths, cyclone apex and filter-press cloths. • Mechanical lifting (chain block, telehandler, MEWP with man-basket) for loads > 20 kg. • Two-person lift protocol for awkward items. • LOLER-inspected lifting accessories only.	2	2	4